

due to Bollywood's weak pipeline.

Meanwhile, Hindi hits remade in the South have also fared well lately, including *Badhaai Ho* (Veetla Vishesham), *Article 15* (Nenjuku Needhi) and *Pink* (Nerkonda Paarvai/Vakeel Saab), even as Bollywood is resting its hopes on two large-scale films—*Shamsher* and the *Brahmāstra* trilogy, both starring Ranbir Kapoor.

But what has rattled Bollywood is the quick succession and scale of the recent southern hits in Hindi. “The only major change in the last two to three years is that dubbing is no longer limited to satellite viewing,” says Ormax Media’s Founder and CEO, Shailesh Kapoor. That one major shift has come as a boon for both single-screens and multiplexes. Trade analyst Sreedhar Pillai points out that major multiplexes did not screen Hindi-dubbed versions of south Indian films even two years ago. “Now, it is their bread and butter because *Pushpa*, *RRR*, *KGF2* and *Vikram* are bringing in the footfalls, which drive food and beverage sales. In the exhibition business, the profits come from the concession stands.”

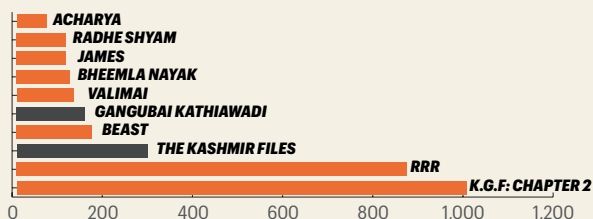


SO, WHAT ARE they doing right? “Content!” Pat comes the reply from almost everybody interviewed for this piece. The stories themselves are not brand new, but the storytelling is. “An uncle killing the father and the son taking revenge can be *Lion King* or *Baahubali* or a stereotypical Bhojpuri film. It’s about how you make that storytelling accessible intellectually to the widest possible audience,” says Nagpur-based exhibitor and distributor Akshaye Rathi, Director of Aashirwad Theatres Pvt. Ltd. Make enough room to weave in larger-than-life action sequences and visual effects organically, and you just may have a winner.

“I put in as few dialogues as possible. I try to communicate everything through visuals. So, language doesn’t play any role at all,” says Rajamouli, an agnostic whose tales are replete with mythological themes of reincarnation and revenge, brought to life using heavy doses of modern-day technologies. Ever the director, he pushes a table outside the Zoom frame for creating too much white space, before settling in for the conversation from Hyderabad. “Language is not a barrier,” he says. “It’s a medium.” Yet, he finds it easiest to make films in Telugu, a language he thinks in. “How do I

THE SOUTHERN RECIPE

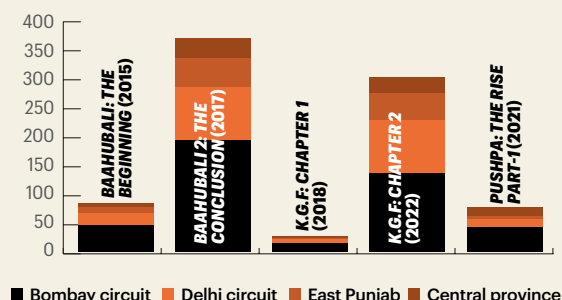
Cumulative box office collections have soared during Jan-Apr 2022, driven by massive hits from south India



ALL FIGURES ARE GROSS COLLECTIONS IN ₹ CRORE
SOURCE GroupM & ORMAX MEDIA REPORT: JAN-APR 2022

THE FRANCHISE GAMBIT

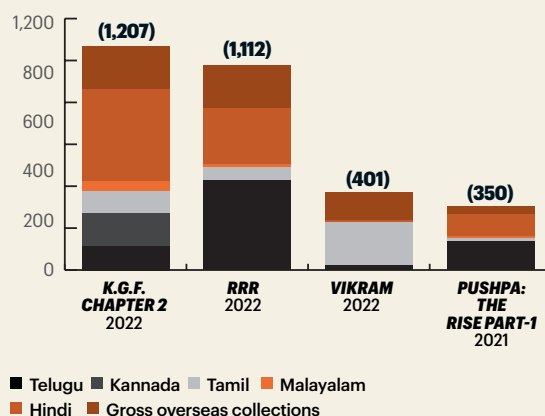
If the first film in a south Indian movie franchise opened up the Hindi markets, the sequel exceeded expectations. *Pushpa*'s sequel is expected to follow this trend



■ Bombay circuit ■ Delhi circuit ■ East Punjab ■ Central province
TERRITORY-WISE NET BOX OFFICE COLLECTIONS OF HINDI-DUBBED VERSIONS IN ₹ CRORE
NOTE: THERE ARE 11 TERRITORIES FOR DISTRIBUTION OF HINDI FILMS IN INDIA, WHICH ARE DIFFERENT FROM THE STATE-CITY-BORDERS. FOR INSTANCE, DELHI CIRCUIT COMPRISES DELHI, UP AND UTTARAKHAND SOURCE BOLLYWOOD HUNGAMA

HOUSE FULL

Not only across India, but movies from the southern states dubbed into Hindi have also had stellar performances in international markets



ALL FIGURES IN ₹ CRORE; LANGUAGE FIGURES ARE NET COLLECTIONS; FIGURES IN BRACKETS INDICATE GROSS WORLDWIDE COLLECTIONS INCLUDING INDIA; FIGURES AS ON JULY 15, 2022; SOURCE SACNLIK